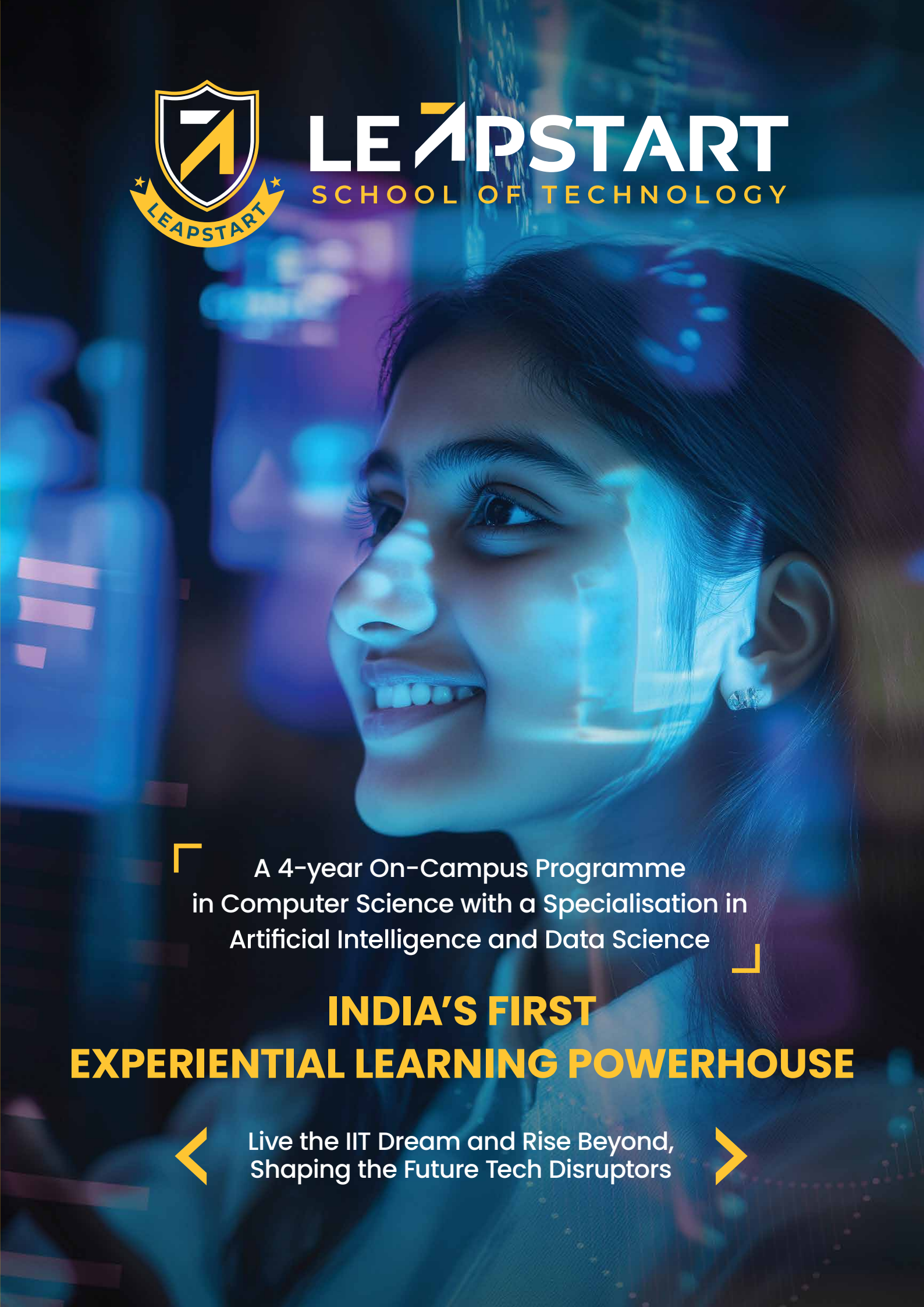
LEAPSTART
SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY
A 4-year On-Campus Programme
in Computer Science with a Specialisation in
Artificial Intelligence and Data Science
INDIA'S FIRST
EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING POWERHOUSE
Live the IIT Dream and Rise Beyond,
Shaping the Future Tech Disruptors

ONLY 10% OF INDIA'S 1.5 MILLION ENGINEERING GRADUATES SET TO SECURE JOBS THIS YEAR: REPORT

NEWS18

Only 10% of India's 1.5 Million Engineering Graduates Set to Secure Jobs This Year: Report

Reported By : Mohammad Haris News18.com

Last Updated: September 13, 2024, 13:08 IST

The need to enhance employability of today's youth is more pressing than ever, given the significant surge in demand for skilled engineers, says Dhriti Prasanna Mahanta, vice president and chief business officer at TeamLease Degree Apprenticeship.

There is a widening gap between academic excellence and industry needs, particularly in emerging fields like semiconductors, AI, and automation, says a TeamLease report. (Representative Image)

Employability among engineering graduates stands at over 60 per cent, with only 45 per cent meeting industry standards. Furthermore, a mere 10 per cent of the 1.5 million engineers expected to graduate this fiscal year are anticipated to secure employment, according to a TeamLease report. The major reason, it said, is the skills gap among engineering graduates.

Hindustan Times @100

TCS has 80,000 open job positions due to skill gap

By Abhyjith K. Ashokan

Quarterly results from IT firms including TCS indicate a significant slowdown in the sector.

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES

The company has 80,000 open positions, highlighting a mismatch between the skills of current employees and the roles needed, causing them to rely on contractors to fill these gaps, Amar Shetye, global operations head of TCS's Resource Management Group (RMG), told the Times of India.

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Also Read | IT majors like Infosys, Wipro, TCS leave 10,000 freshers in limbo as onboarding deferred

"We were told that either skillsets or employee aspirations are not matching project requirements," an anonymous employee told the Times of India.

Indian IT majors, including TCS, have been delaying the onboarding of freshers, leaving many without confirmed joining dates. Over 10,000 freshers have been affected by these delays over the past two years, according to the Nascent Information Technology Employees Senate (NITES).

CNBC

Why industries complain about the unemployability of fresh engineering graduates

As per the ideal educational standards and practice, the time spent by engineering students in the industry is highly valuable both in terms of their skill-assessment as well as their future in the profession. But unfortunately, for generations, we are in a situation where the engineering education system had no link with the industry. So no surprise if the graduates are misfit for the work, observes education expert and writer Dr V Premachandran.

ET THE ECONOMIC TIMES

India's skill gap crisis: Plenty of graduates, not enough leadersfor emerging tech

Synopsis

India is grappling with a significant skills gap in the tech sector, with a shortage in emerging technology talents like AI, ML, and cybersecurity. Reports indicate that India needs extensive reskilling and standardizing frameworks to align the workforce with industry needs while investing in continuous learning and academia collaboration.

The Indian EXPRESS
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

Skills over degrees: 80% employers prioritise practical experience, says Indeed report

Teamwork, communication, adaptability, and critical thinking are among the most sought-after qualities.

If you are planning for a career switch, we recommend upskilling. A new report by Indeed, a global matching and hiring platform, suggests that over 80 per cent of employers have adopted a skills-first strategy, indicating a broader shift towards practical expertise across industries. In simple words, a growing number of employers are focusing more on skills and experiences than formal degrees.

THE TIMES OF INDIA

Degree vs. Skill: Why is India producing graduates with low employability quotient?

TOI Education / Oct 26, 2024, 13:15 IST

A study by Mercer | Mettl reveals that only 45% of Indian graduates possess the necessary skills for the job market, with 53% employable in non-technical roles versus 44% in technical positions. Factors such as a curriculum mismatch, limited soft skills training, and inadequate preparation for technical roles contribute to this issue, highlighting the need for targeted skill development.

Business Standard

Home / Economy / News / India faces growing job crisis: Just 42.6% of graduates are employable

India faces growing job crisis: Just 42.6% of graduates are employable

India's job crisis deepens as only 42.6 per cent of graduates are employable, sparking concerns over the growing skill gap in an AI-driven workforce

BS

India's job market is at a crossroads. As industries evolve with artificial intelligence (AI) and automation, fresh graduates are struggling to keep up. A new report, India's Graduate Skill Index 2025 by Mercer-Mettl, reveals that only 42.6 per cent of Indian graduates are employable — marking a decline from 44.3 per cent in 2023.

The biggest challenge: A widening gap between what employers need and the skills graduates have. While technical skills like AI and data analytics are in high demand, non-technical abilities such as communication, problem-solving, and creativity are lagging behind. This has made it harder for many fresh graduates to secure jobs.

Business Standard

BS

India's main challenge is skills gap for young: FM Nirmala Sitharaman

INDIA TODAY

India's education system needs urgent reform to bridg unemployment issue. (AI-generated image)

INDIA TODAY

India's skill gap is stealing futures: How right education can tackle the job crisis

India's education system needs urgent reform to bridge the skills gap, which can help solve the unemployment issue.

India Today Education Desk
New Delhi, UPDATED: Nov 1, 2024 18:05 IST

The World Economic Forum (WEF) report highlights a need to address and bridge the skills gap in India's workforce. It shows out of the 13 million people who join the workforce per year, only one-fourth of the management professionals, one-fifth of engineers, and one-tenth of graduates are employable.

In addition, the Global Skills Gaps Measurement and Monitoring Report of ILO 2023 indicates that **47% of Indian workers, especially 62% of females are underqualified for their jobs.**

There is an urgent need to address this disparity between industry-demanded skills and the existing educational and training frameworks.

India, with one of the highest young populations, has a strategic advantage in addressing the evolving needs of the workforce globally.

The Economic Survey 2023-24 also highlights the challenges and disparities between education and employment, emphasising the need for skill development to reshape the nation's future workforce.

> Only 1 in 5 engineers and 1 in 10 graduates entering the workforce are employable—highlighting the significant skill gap caused by the disconnect between academia and industry, further compounded by rapid technological advancements.
>
> **– World Economic Forum**

The Alarming Reality

Indian Engineering Education at a Crossroads

India's engineering education system is at a critical juncture. While technology is evolving at a breakneck pace, the gap between academia and industry continues to widen. A NASSCOM report reveals that only 10% of Indian engineering graduates are employable immediately upon graduation, primarily due to a significant disconnect between what colleges teach and what industries require.

The traditional approach emphasizes rote learning, age-old curricula, and theoretical assessments, leaving students ill-equipped for the real-world challenges of a rapidly transforming industry. Meanwhile, fields like Data Science and Artificial Intelligence are emerging, demanding professionals who can innovate, adapt, and solve complex problems.

To address this misalignment, a fundamental overhaul of the system is required. Curricula must incorporate hands-on projects, interdisciplinary learning, and industry-aligned applications such as internships and live problem-solving exercises. By prioritizing a culture of adaptability and continuous learning, India can empower its engineering graduates to not only meet industry expectations but redefine them. Bridging this gap is not just essential—it is urgent.

A Wake-Up Call for

Transforming Engineering Education

The challenges in engineering education are undeniable: graduates struggling to find their place, parents anxious about their children's futures, and industries facing a shortage of job-ready professionals. While the problem has been widely acknowledged, effective solutions remain scarce.

Behind every statistic lies a story—a student striving for their dreams, a parent investing their hopes in a degree, and a society relying on its engineers to drive progress. The question is no longer, "What's wrong?" but, "How do we fix this?"

As industries rapidly advance with transformative technologies like Artificial Intelligence (AI), Data Science, and Cloud Computing, traditional education struggles to keep up. By 2028, India's IT sector is set to generate 2.73 million new jobs, with soaring demand for roles like Software Developers and Data Engineers. AI alone is projected to add $17 billion to the economy by 2027, growing at an annual rate of 25–35%.

Yet, despite this explosive growth, nearly 80% of engineering graduates remain unprepared—held back by outdated curricula and a lack of real-world experience. The gap between education and industry has never been wider, making experiential learning the key to shaping future-ready tech talent.

The need is clear: not incremental change but a complete rethinking of how we educate our engineers. We must emphasize practical learning, align education with industry demands, and nurture the confidence to lead. This vision aligns with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, which champions experiential learning and collaboration between academia and industry. Realizing this vision, however, demands bold action and collective effort.

LeapStart School of Technology
Founding Team

Introducing
LeapStart
School of Technology

LeapStart School of Technology is redefining engineering education by combining cutting-edge technology, industry-aligned insights, and a transformative experiential learning model. As India's first experiential learning powerhouse, LeapStart goes beyond traditional rote learning to prepare students for the challenges of tomorrow's AI-driven workforce. By bridging the gap between academia and industry, LeapStart empowers students with technical expertise, critical thinking, and adaptability, ensuring they graduate as leaders and disruptors in fields like AI, Machine Learning, and Data Science.

Designed by professors from top national and international universities and industry experts, LeapStart transforms classrooms into dynamic innovation hubs, setting a new benchmark for engineering education in India.

At LeapStart, experiential learning forms the foundation of its approach, structured through Discovery, Exploration, Practice, and Action. From day one, students engage in hands-on projects, internships, and hackathons, solving real-world challenges and building software applications. Guided by experienced industry mentors, students analyze project outcomes, receive actionable feedback, and implement innovative strategies to craft unique solutions for real-world challenges

At LeapStart, experiential learning forms the foundation of its approach, structured through Discovery, Exploration, Practice, and Action.

Prestigious LeapStart Industry Master Certificate

IIT Prestige Meets Real-World Mastery

Why settle for just a degree when you can own the future? In an era where AI is rewriting the rules of the global economy, the winners will be those who possess both elite credentials and the raw capability to build.

At **LeapStart,** we recommend our students independently enroll in the prestigious **4-year BS Degree in Applied AI and Data Science from IIT Jodhpur.** We don't just help you study for a degree; we transform you into a technical powerhouse. By aligning your academic journey at IIT Jodhpur with our cutting-edge, hands-on curriculum and mentorship from **50+ global tech titans**, you aren't just getting an education—you're launching a career.

Advisory Board

Prof. K. Pattabhiraman
Academician | Director, IT Logix India

Pattabhiraman K, a BITS Pilani alumnus with 40+ years of experience, is a visionary in product design and innovation. He has pioneered industry-academia programs, mentored numerous careers, and driven global innovation with acclaimed technologies in automation and market-ready solutions.

Krishna Pidatala
International Development Specialist
Former Sr. World Bank Official

Krishna Pidatala, a seasoned international development expert with 30+ years at the World Bank, has led transformative initiatives in digital infrastructure, social protection, and agricultural productivity across 35+ countries. An advocate for digital technology in development, he brings expertise in project implementation, impact evaluation, and fostering public-private partnerships, with a career spanning Africa, South Asia, and the Middle East.

Lokesh Kumar Manikonda
Ex-Country Head, Novartis

Lokesh Kumar Manikonda, Executive Vice President, is a global health expert with 28+ years of experience in healthcare and pharmaceuticals. As Country Head of Novartis Social Business India, he expanded Arogya Parivar to 18 states, impacting 90 million rural Indians with healthcare access and education. A visionary leader, he is recognized for driving sustainable, inclusive healthcare solutions worldwide.

Scott E. Augenbaum
Cybercrime Prevention Trainer @ CyberSecure Mindset
Retired FBI Agent

Scott E., a retired FBI Supervisory Special Agent with 30+ years of experience combating cybercrime, is a renowned cybersecurity author, trainer, and speaker. Since 2018, he has delivered tailored cybersecurity awareness sessions worldwide, authored The Secret to CyberSecurity, and appeared on major networks like CNN and FOX to empower individuals and organizations against cybercrime.

P. Ganeswara Rao
Ex-CCM, South Central Railway
Director, Celestial IT Services

P. Ganeswara Rao, former Chief Commercial Manager of South Central Railway, brings decades of expertise in operations and strategic management. Now Director at Celestial IT Services, he drives innovation and efficiency in IT solutions, bridging the gap between technology and operational excellence.

Arun Kumar B R
Software Consultant-TITAN Company Ltd

Arun Kumar B. R., Consultant at TITAN Company Ltd., brings over 16 years of expertise in technology solutions, specializing in RFID systems, gaming solutions, CRM, and premium electronic security products. Having held leadership roles at global organizations like New York Technology Partners and Merlinhawk Aerospace, he excels in driving innovative tech strategies and operational excellence.

Advisory Board

Kartik Donepudi

Founder & CTO, Quill AI | Y Combinator-backed Entrepreneur

Kartik Donepudi is the Founder and CTO of Quill AI, a cutting-edge fintech startup backed by Y Combinator (S23). With a sharp focus on automation in financial analysis, Kartik is building AI-powered tools that are reshaping how analysts extract insights from SEC filings. Under his leadership, Quill AI raised $500,000 in pre-seed funding in 2023. Kartik brings a builder's mindset, a deep understanding of AI, and startup grit to LeapStart's vision of real-world tech education.

Apoorv Shankar

Product Designer | Hardware Innovator | Builder of Iconic Tech Products

Apoorv Shankar is an engineer-turned-product designer known for building intuitive consumer hardware that blends form, function, and user-first design. He has led the development of Ultrahuman's flagship products—including the Red Dot Award-winning Ring R1 and the world's lightest health wearable, Ring Air. Apoorv also set up the company's in-house manufacturing unit, Ultrafactory, in Bangalore, and later expanded it to Texas. At LeapStart, he brings the mindset of a maker, combining design thinking with deep-tech innovation to inspire the next generation of builders.

Mehul Mohan

Founder & CEO, Codedamn & Fermion | Tech Educator | Learning Architect

Mehul Mohan is the Founder and CEO of Codedamn, an interactive learning platform for developers, and Fermion, a tool designed to help educators launch scalable, hands-on coding academies. A BITS Pilani alumnus and WWDC 2019 Scholar, Mehul has created content that has empowered over 25 million learners worldwide. His mission? Making tech education immersive, accessible, and deeply practical. At LeapStart, Mehul helps bridge the gap between learning and doing—bringing a product-builder's mindset and a real-world approach to shaping the next generation of tech talent.

Mithesh Lohiya

Director, Lohiya Group | Business Leader | Co-founder, Street Cause

Mitesh Lohiya is a business leader with a strong foundation in engineering and strategic management. A chemical engineer from CBIT and a postgraduate in MFAB from the Indian School of Business, he currently leads sales and marketing at the Lohiya Group. As co-founder of Street Cause, one of India's largest youth-led NGOs, Mitesh has empowered thousands of students to lead community-driven change. At LeapStart, he brings a unique perspective that blends entrepreneurship, social responsibility, and leadership—inspiring students to think beyond the classroom and build with purpose, impact, and real-world relevance.

Nikhil Velpanur

Senior Director, AWS | TED Fellow | Innovation Leader

Nikhil Velpanur is a TED Fellow and Senior Director at Amazon AWS, where he leads initiatives across Partnerships, Fundraising, Communications, and the AI Hub. He is also the Principal of Digital Innovation and heads Web3 & JIC at AWS. A thought leader at the forefront of emerging technologies, Nikhil brings unmatched insight into cloud, AI, and digital ecosystems. His presence at LeapStart inspires students to dream big, build boldly, and drive meaningful change through tech.

Charlie Shelly

VP of Sales | InsurTech & FinTech Growth Leader

Charlie Shelly is a seasoned sales executive and current VP of Sales at a leading FinTech/InsurTech company. With an MBA and a passion for leveraging innovation to solve real-world problems, he is transforming the residential real estate space through future-ready financial solutions. Known for building high-performing teams and scaling revenue, Charlie offers LeapStart students a masterclass in leadership, business strategy, and growth in fast-evolving industries.

A Tailored

4-Year Curriculum

to Accelerate Your Career

Our four-year curriculum in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence is strategically crafted to deliver a transformative learning experience, seamlessly blending foundational principles with cutting-edge concepts and real-world applications. Each year is designed to build on the last, ensuring continuous growth and preparing students to excel in the dynamic tech industry.

Central to this approach is a strong emphasis on experiential learning, empowering students to apply theoretical knowledge through hands-on projects, internships, and collaborative work.

01

Building a Strong Foundation in Technology & Problem-Solving

Students develop core skills in engineering, mathematics, Python, and SQL, with a strong emphasis on real-world problem-solving.

02

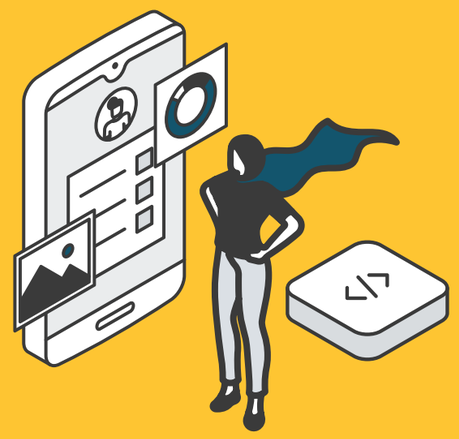
Mastering Emerging Tech Trends & Learning Managerial Skills

Students dive deep into the latest tech trends, including AI, machine learning, and cybersecurity, while establishing essential management foundations, preparing them to lead tomorrow's tech-driven industries.

03

Developing Real-Time Applications & Mastering Leadership Skills

Students engage in practical learning, creating real-time solutions and mastering the essential leadership skills necessary for professional growth.



04

Be Industry-Ready & Future-Driven

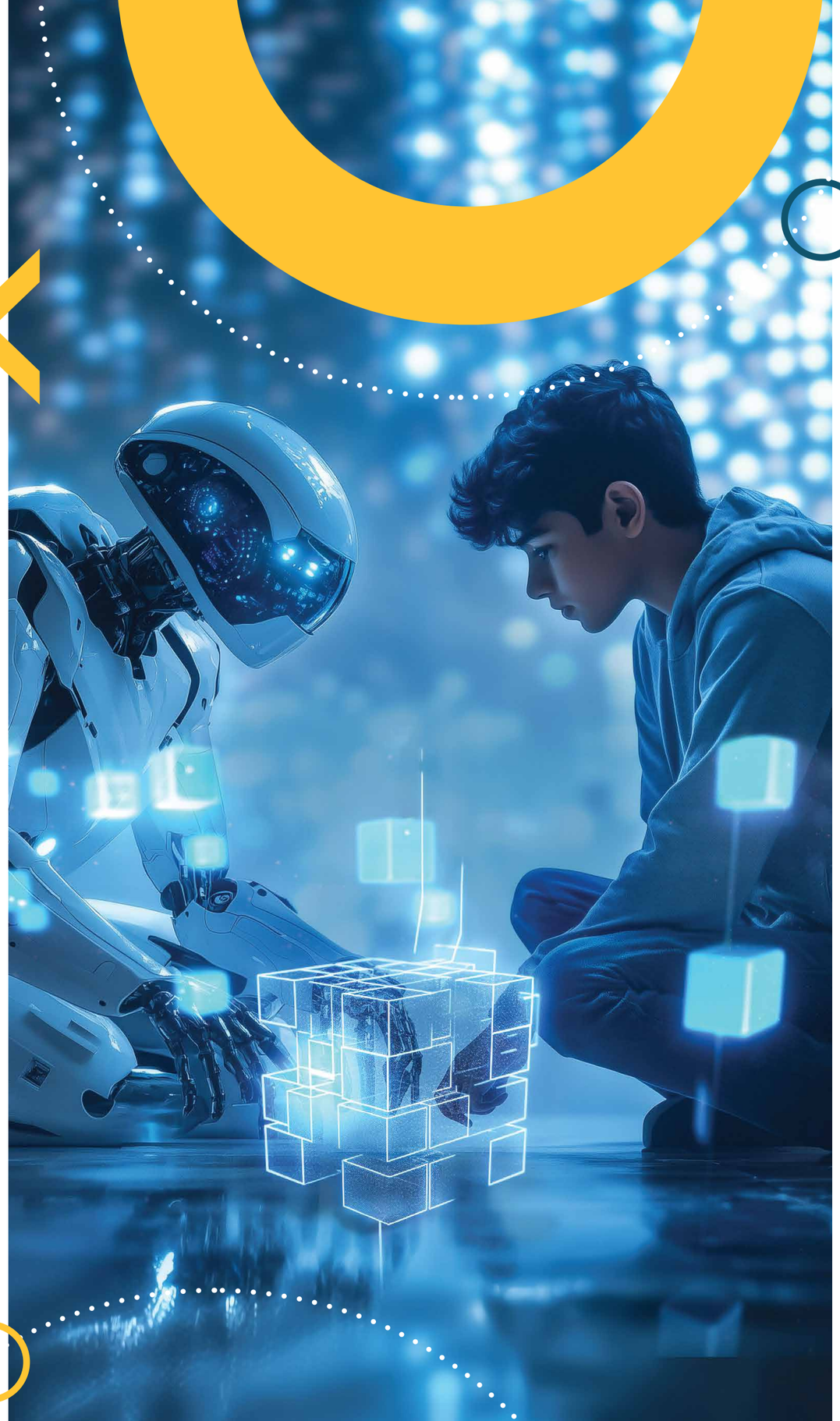
The program culminates in a capstone project, followed by a paid internship or idea incubation. With opportunities for job placement or pursuing advanced studies abroad, students are empowered to step confidently into the future.

LeapStart's

Pedagogy

to Skill Building

LeapStart's pedagogy to skill-building is built on the core principles of experiential learning, following a structured framework of Discovery, Exploration, Practice, and Action. Students understand industry demands, gain insights from mentors and masterclasses, apply knowledge through projects and internships, and solve real-world challenges to build essential professional skills.



01

Agile Learning Environment

An adaptive and dynamic learning environment, designed to evolve with industry trends and empower students to thrive in an ever-changing tech landscape.

02

Reverse Engineered Curriculum

A curriculum designed by analyzing industry demands and reverse engineering the skill-building process to equip students for solving real-world challenges from Day One.

03

One-on-One Mentoring

Personalized mentoring through monthly one-on-one sessions with industry leaders, guiding you toward success.

04

Master by Building Real-World Applications

Build 50+ real-world applications to enhance practical skills, problem-solving abilities, and gain global recognition through GSOC, ACM ICPC, and hackathons.

05

Internship Driven Learning

Gain hands-on experience with year-round internships at top tech giants, bridging academic learning with real-world growth.

06

Learn from CEOs & CXOs

Gain expert guidance from CEOs, CXOs, and Tech innovators through regular masterclasses, gaining strategic insights

PROGRAM HIGHLIGHTS

1. Industry-Focused Learning

We deliver a hands-on curriculum that combines academic excellence with practical experience, ensuring students are fully prepared for the real world.

3. Masterclasses by CEOs/CXOs

Gain exclusive access to masterclasses by top CEOs and CXOs, where you'll learn from industry leaders and innovators. Expand your horizons by participating in global events, hackathons, and tech meet-ups, fostering collaboration, networking, and real-world problem-solving.

4. Mentorship by Industry Leaders

Gain industry insights and entrepreneurial skills through mentoring, workshops, and seminars led by professionals, designed for real-world impact.

5. Makeathons & Hackathons

Build real-world solutions through hands-on Makeathons—whether technical, entrepreneurial, or technopreneurial. Develop prototypes, pitch ideas, and kickstart your innovation journey.

6. Master 100+ AI Tools

Master over 100 cutting-edge AI tools and become an AI power user. Progress from entry-level roles to specialised domains like Data Science and NLP. Learn secret AI tools like Devin AI, Claude, and more.

7. Idea Incubation-build your own startup

Transform your ideas into impactful solutions with hands-on startup support, founder-led mentorship, and entrepreneurial workshops.

8. LeapX Clubs

A vibrant hub where tech enthusiasts, creatives, athletes, and performers come together to learn, build, and grow. From AI to art, sports to stage — diverse clubs offer every student a platform to innovate, express, and thrive.

Note: Students who join LeapStart will also be enrolled in IIT Jodhpur's 4-year remote learning B.S. degree program in Applied Artificial Intelligence and Data Science, through which they will earn their degree.

Industry Mentors

DHANANJAY YADAV
Founder, CEO

neosapien

Ex. simplilearn, Home Lane

AMAR CHAITANYA KENGUVA
Founder, CEO

Analytica

Ex. accenture, Shell

RAJ KAMAL
Co-founder

atobic

Ex. amazon, Qualcomm

CHAITANYA YAKKALI
Senior Data Engineer

TCS TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES

Ex. accenture, Tech Mahindra

SAI KIRAN MADA
Senior Software Engineer

Medtronic

Ex. HCL, L&T Technology Services

SAJEED SHAIK
Tech Lead

Advisor360°

Ex. Deloitte., redBus.in

ARJIT JOHRI
Vice President

MARS SHOT VC

Ex. BHARAT INNOVATION FUND BY CIIE.CO, EY

AKHIL NAIDU
CTO

ContentQL

Ex. Leewardslope, Hasura

RAGHAVENDRA KUMAR R
Manager for AI & Data Practice

EY

Ex. accenture, HCL

JETENDRA IVATURI
Senior Enterprises Engineer

ATLASSIAN

Ex. HCL, ORACLE

SANTHOSHI PRAVEENA
Senior Software Engineer

planit

Ex. virtusa, Deloitte.

ANUSHA KOLAGOTLA
Technical Lead

Tech Mahindra

Ex. Walmart, UnitedHealth Group

Conventional Learning

- Earn a regular Bachelor's degree
- Outdated & focus only on theory
- Lack real-world exposure
- No real time projects
- Limited or no internship opportunities.
- Pursue additional certifications or accept an entry-level salary.
- No opportunity to exchange ideas or collaborate with industry experts
- Focus just on theoretical knowledge and achieving grades

Degree
Curriculum
Educators
Projects
Internship
After 4 Years
Industry Connects
Beyond Academics

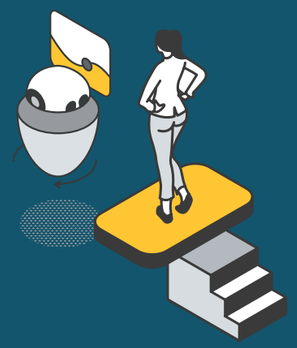
LeapStart Learning

- Earn an IIT Bachelor's degree and prestigious IIT alumni status
- Reverse-engineered curriculum aligned with industry demands, bridging the skill gap
- Top IIT faculty & leading industry experts who bring hands-on industry experience of solving real-world problems
- Build 50+ real-world, industry-grade applications to showcase in-demand skills, creating a job-ready portfolio.
- 6-month mandatory paid internship and 4,160 hours of building real-world applications & solving industry problems.
- Work in specialist roles or equivalent or build your own startup
- Opportunity to network with influential tech leaders, CEOs, CXOs and innovators
- Prioritise academics and skill-building through experiential, project-based learning.

Career
Outcomes

Earn 30-50% more!

Kick-start your career with competitive salaries that outpace entry-level roles



Step into high-impact & growth roles early!

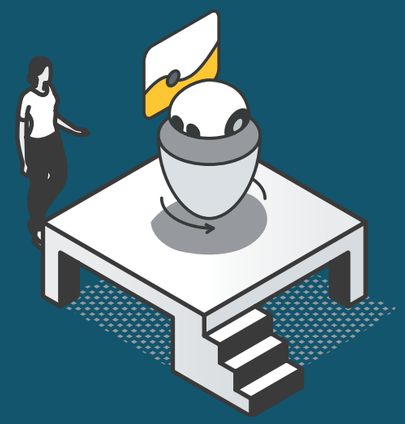
Fast track careers, getting ahead of peers and entering high-impact & growth positions.

Dream Big, Go Global!

Become globally skilled and become a top choice for MNCs

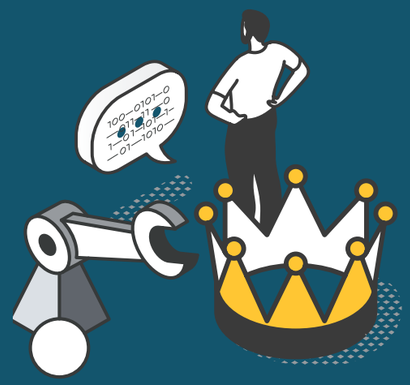
Lead with confidence!

Gain leadership skills through specialised courses and expand your professional network with direct connections to industry leaders.



Transforming Ideas into Impact!

Turn ideas into ventures, mastering the skills to launch, scale, and lead.



Grow Stronger, Grow Smarter

Spend 4 years with a growth-driven, tech-focused cohort, advancing 1% every day

LeapStart's

Roadmap to Your Dream Job

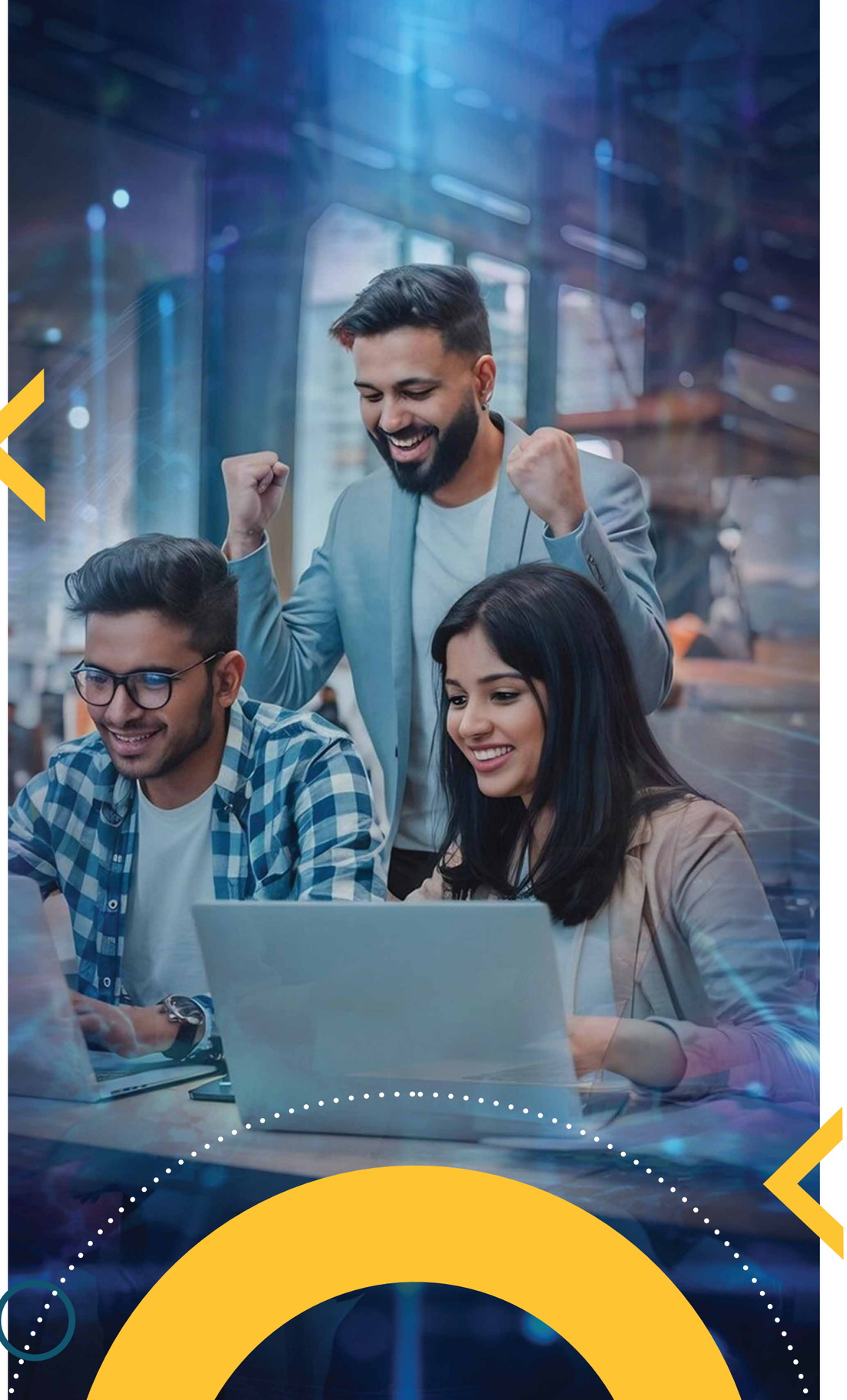
Our 6 Step Placement Assistance:

01
Career Discovery & Goal Setting

Understanding your strengths, interests, and aspirations to create a personalized career trajectory.

02
Personal Branding & Resume Excellence

Crafting a powerful resume, optimizing your LinkedIn presence, and building a portfolio that grabs recruiter attention.



03
Smart Job Role Matching

Aligning your skills with the right opportunities, ensuring a perfect match with industry-leading employers.

04
Advanced Interview Readiness

Mastering technical, behavioral,and problem-solving skills through expert-led mock interviews and coaching

05
Industry Access & Exclusive Hiring Opportunities

Connecting you with top recruiters, mentors, and industry leaders through networking events and hiring drives

06
Lifelong Career Support & Growth

Providing ongoing mentorship, skill enhancement, and career progression strategies to help you thrive in the tech industry.

Strategically located in the heart of a tech metropolis, surrounded by leading global tech giants.

LeapStart School of Technology, surrounded by global tech giants like Amazon, Microsoft, and Google, places students at the heart of innovation. This prime location offers unmatched exposure, industry connections, and opportunities for mentorship, internships, and collaboration.

Our location isn't just a choice; it's a commitment to creating an environment where students can dream big, learn smarter, and achieve greater heights

LEAPSTART
SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY

TAKE THE LEAP. LEAD THE FUTURE.

Phone & Whatsapp

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Online

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www.leapstart.in

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